

Enterprise Knowledge Base - Password Management

Purpose: Standard troubleshooting guide for Service Desk (L1/L2) engineers handling password-related incidents.

Scenario 1 – Password Expired

Symptoms

User receives 'Password Expired' message, cannot access Windows, VPN, Outlook or corporate applications.

Possible Causes

Password reached expiry policy, account inactive, password synchronization delay.

Validation Steps

Verify employee ID, username, account status in Active Directory/Identity Portal, confirm expiry date, verify MFA registration.

Resolution Steps

Direct user to Self-Service Password Reset (SSPR). Authenticate using registered MFA (Authenticator App/SMS/Email). Create a password meeting policy (minimum length, upper/lower case, number, special character, no previous passwords). Ask user to reconnect VPN and lock/unlock workstation to synchronize cached credentials.

Escalate When

SSPR unavailable, MFA unavailable, AD replication failure, privileged account, repeated synchronization failures.

Scenario 2 – Password Reset Failed

Symptoms

Password reset completed but login still fails.

Possible Causes

Password not synchronized to cloud, cached credentials, replication delay.

Validation Steps

Check whether reset completed successfully, verify latest password timestamp, test login via web portal.

Resolution Steps

Wait 10–15 minutes for synchronization. Connect through VPN. Restart device. Sign out from Office applications and sign back in. Clear cached credentials if required.

Escalate When

Password still rejected after replication period.

Scenario 3 – MFA Failure

Symptoms

User cannot approve MFA notification, OTP not received, authenticator unavailable.

Possible Causes

Mobile offline, wrong time sync, deleted authenticator, changed phone, blocked SMS.

Validation Steps

Verify registered phone, internet connectivity, date/time synchronization, alternate authentication methods.

Resolution Steps

Use alternate verification method if enabled. Re-register authenticator after identity verification. Temporary MFA bypass only according to security policy.

Escalate When

No registered authentication factor or suspected account compromise.

Scenario 4 – Account Locked

Symptoms

Account locked after multiple invalid attempts.

Possible Causes

Incorrect password, stale credentials on mobile, mapped drives, scheduled tasks.

Validation Steps

Review lockout source, event logs, AD lockout tools.

Resolution Steps

Unlock account after user verification. Update stored credentials on all devices. Restart applications using old password.

Escalate When

Repeated lockouts from unknown systems.

Scenario 5 – Password Policy Questions

Symptoms

User asks acceptable password format.

Possible Causes

Corporate security policy.

Validation Steps

Review policy version.

Resolution Steps

Minimum 12 characters, uppercase, lowercase, numeric, special character. Avoid names, employee IDs, company name, dictionary words. Recommend passphrases and password manager.

Escalate When

Policy exception request.